Day 34 - Hockley Heights, Hemlock Ridge, Glacier Valley

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Caledon Hills section · hike 43 · Hockley Heights & Mono forest tracts

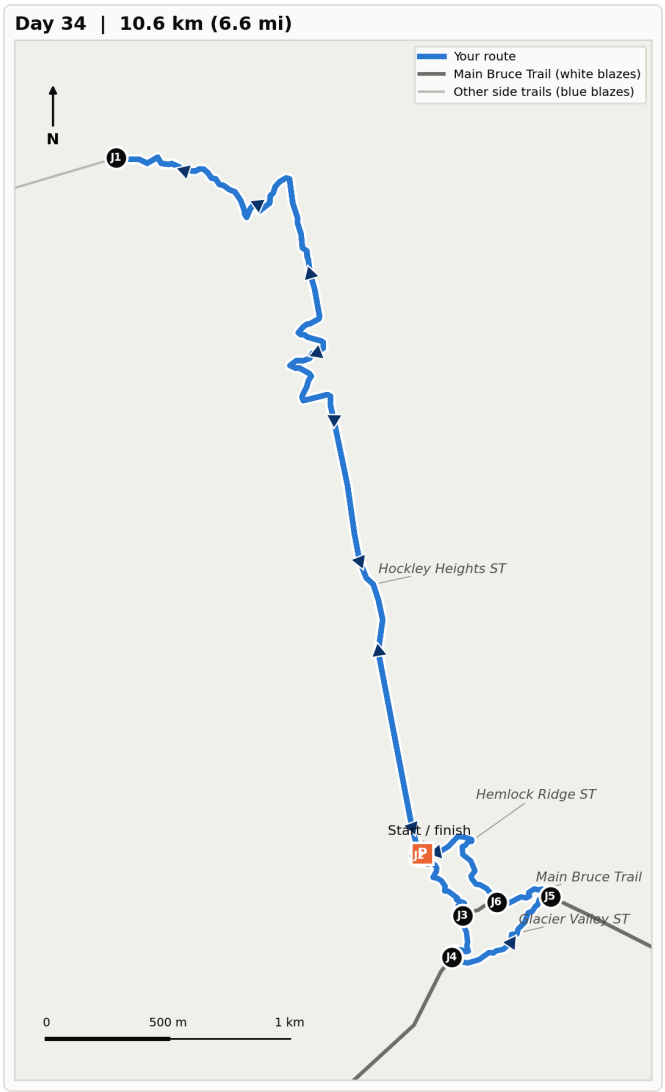
10.6 km / 6.6 mi	~3.0 h	5.9 km new	61 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Bruce Trail parking on the east side of the 5th Line EHS, just south of the Hockley Rd. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day34_hike043.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Hockley Heights Side Trail (4.7 km); Hemlock Ridge Side Trail (0.6 km); Glacier Valley Side Trail (0.6 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** the Bruce Trail lot on the east side of 5th Line EHS, just south of Hockley Rd.
- **Hockley Heights Side Trail:** the club calls it strenuous, with steep hills and valleys. It runs through pine and maple forest planted by Mono Township from 1926, partly by local Boys and Girls' Forestry Clubs. At the top is the 100-acre Anderson Tract, marked by a Town of Mono sign.
- **Road walking:** parts of the Hockley Heights Side Trail follow road shoulders. Keep the dog close.
- **Hemlock Ridge Side Trail:** follows a steep-sided ridge built from glacial meltwater sediment, with eastern hemlocks (some of this species live over 500 years). The club notes the steep sides make a good workout.
- **Glacier Valley Side Trail:** a 580 m path through a forested valley. Near its eastern end with the main Trail is a marked sugar maple that ecologists date to before Confederation (1867).
- **Dogs:** allowed on leash throughout. Bring plenty of water for both of you on the hills.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Bruce Trail parking on the east side of the 5th Line EHS, just south of the Hockley Rd. Head north on the blue-blazed Hockley Heights Side Trail. The next 1.8 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.8	1.1	Heads-up: The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
2.7	1.7	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
4.2	2.6	J1: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.2	3.2	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
6.3	3.9	Heads-up: The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
6.7	4.1	Heads-up: The next 1.8 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.

8.5	5.3	J2: You pass the start again. Keep going on the blue-blazed Hockley Heights Side Trail, heading south-east.
8.9	5.5	J3: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
9.2	5.7	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Glacier Valley Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
9.7	6.0	J5: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
10.0	6.2	J6: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Hemlock Ridge Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
10.6	6.6	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Caledon Hills Bruce Trail Club's Hockley Heights, Hemlock Ridge and Glacier Valley side-trail stories.